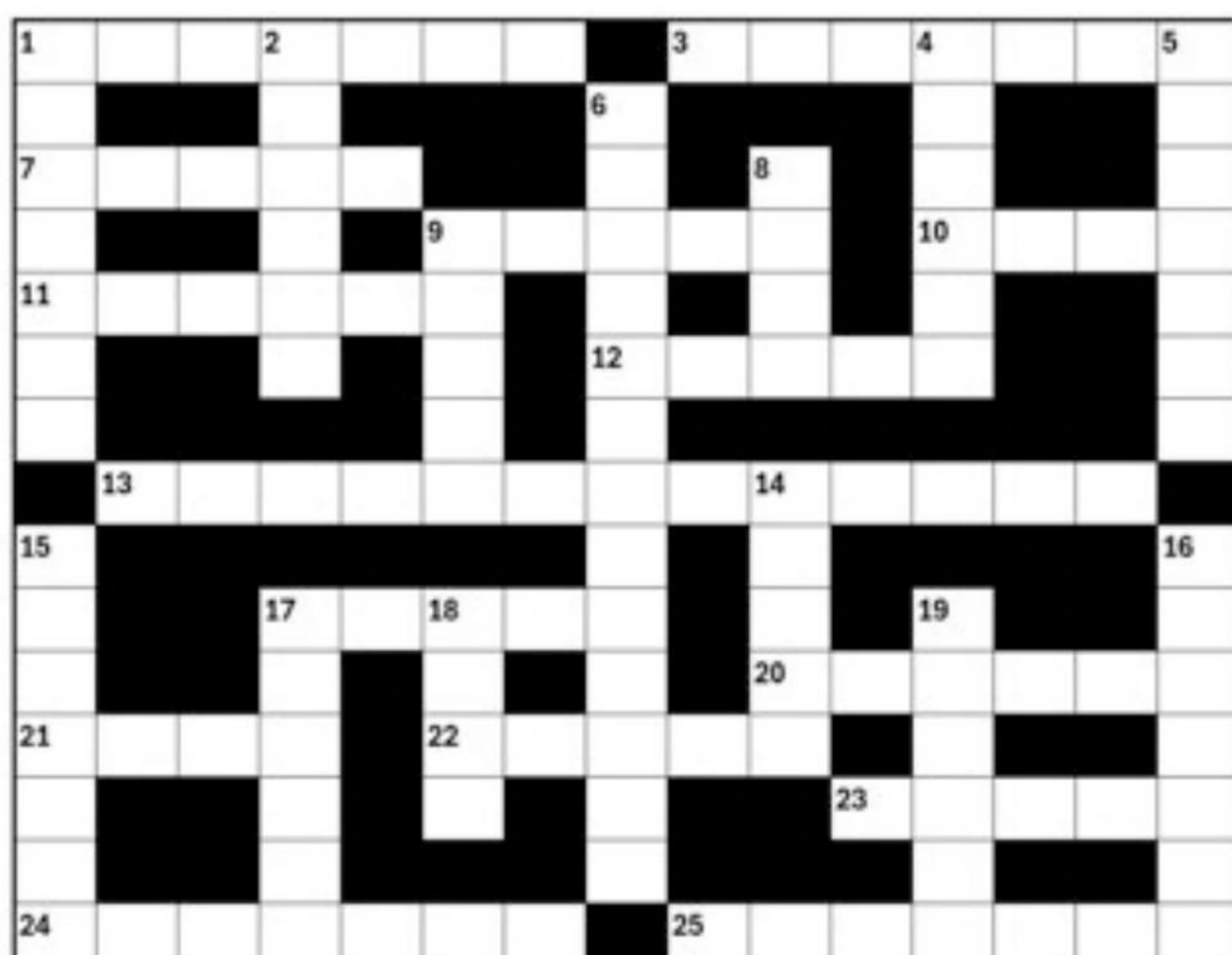


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

FOOTBALL WORLD CUP SPECIAL

ACROSS

- 1 Identify the first name of this footballer who is the only player to score hat-tricks in two successive World Cups. (7)
- 3 Identify the first name of this player who is considered to be the best footballer from Peru and whom Pele referred to as his successor; he also scored a World Cup hat-trick in the 1970 edition. (7)
- 7 Identify the surname of this outstanding footballer from Italy who not only won the Golden Boot but also the Golden Ball award in 1982. (5)
- 9 Identify the surname of this footballer from Argentina who scored his side's second goal in the 2022 final. (5)
- 10 Identify the surname of this German who was the captain when it won the World Cup in 2014. (4)
- 11 Which continent was awarded and hosted the World Cup in 2010? (6)
- 12 Which country hosted the 1982 edition? (5)
- 13 Which legendary player's nickname is El Pibe de Oro ("The Golden Boy")? (5,8)
- 17 Identify the first name of this English footballer who led the side in the final group encounter versus Costa Rica on June 24, 2014. (5)

- 20 Which country has the distinction of being the only one to have participated in all 22 editions of the World Cup held so far? (6)
- 21 Identify the first name of this Serbian who is the only person to have been the manager of five different countries in five consecutive World Cups. (4)
- 22 Identify the surname of this English-born footballer who played a stellar role in taking Albania to a historic playoff in the 2026 World Cup qualifications. (5)
- 23 Identify the first name of this Turkish footballer who holds the record for scoring the fastest goal in World Cup history. (5)
- 24 This Portuguese legend was the top goal-scorer in the 1966 edition. (7)

DOWN

- 1 Which country has reached the World Cup final the most times? (7)
- 2 Which country hosted the 2018 edition of the World Cup? (6)
- 4 Identify the surname of the player who won the Golden Ball award in the 2010 edition. (6)
- 5 Identify the first name of this Frenchman who figured in both 2018 and 2022 teams and is also one of the 10 players to have won the World Cup, UEFA Champions League and Ballon d'Or. (7)

- 6 Who holds the record for scoring most number of goals in the history of the World Cup? (8,5)
- 8 Identify the popular name of this legendary Brazilian who not only scored on his World Cup debut match in 2006 but also won the man of the match award. (4)
- 9 & Across 25 Who became the first person to win the World Cup both as a player and coach? (5,7)
- 14 Identify the surname of the captain of the Austrian team which has qualified for the 2026 tournament after a gap of 28 years. (5)
- 15 Identify the surname of this Argentine, who finished as the highest goal-scorer of the very first edition held in 1930. (7)
- 16 Identify the surname of this Russian who holds the record of scoring most goals — 5, in a single match. (7)
- 17 Just Fontaine, who holds the record of scoring most goals in a single edition, is from which country? (6)
- 18 Identify the surname of one of the best left-backs from Spain, who had represented his nation in three consecutive World Cups from 2014 to 2022. (4)
- 19 Which country is hosting the World Cup for the first time this year as one of the co-host? (6)